Glossary

From Wikipedia, the free encyclopedia

For Wikipedia's glossary, see Wikipedia:Glossary.
Further information: Wikipedia:Contents/Glossaries

A **glossary** (from Ancient Greek: γλῶσσα, *glossa*; language, speech, wording), also known as a **vocabulary** or **clavis**, is an alphabetical list of terms in a particular domain of knowledge with the definitions for those terms.[*citation needed*] Traditionally, a glossary appears at the end of a book and includes terms within that book that are either newly introduced, uncommon, or specialized. While glossaries are most commonly associated with non-fiction books, in some cases, fiction novels sometimes include a glossary for unfamiliar terms.

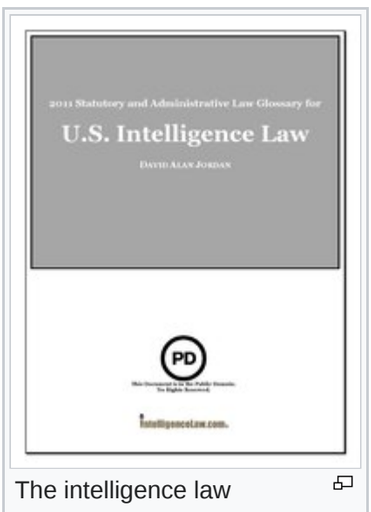
A glossary of Islamic legal terminology

A bilingual glossary is a list of terms in one language defined in a second language or glossed by synonyms (or at least near-synonyms) in another language.

In a general sense, a glossary contains explanations of concepts relevant to a certain field of study or action. In this sense, the term is related to the notion of ontology. Automatic methods have been also provided that transform a glossary into an ontology[1] or a computational lexicon.[2]

Core glossary [edit]

A *core glossary* is a simple glossary or explanatory dictionary that enables definition of other concepts, especially for newcomers to a language or field of study. It contains a small working vocabulary and definitions for important or frequently encountered concepts, usually including idioms or metaphors useful in a culture.



The intelligence law glossary provides a description of the key terms in intelligence law.

Automatic extraction of glossaries [edit]

Computational approaches to the automated extraction of glossaries from corpora[3] or the Web[4][5] have been developed in the recent years[*timeframe?*]. These methods typically start from domain terminology and extract one or more glosses for each term of interest. Glosses can then be analyzed to extract hypernyms of the defined term and other lexical and semantic relations.

See also [edit]

- Controlled vocabulary
- Dictionary
- *Frahang-i Pahlavig*, a glossary of Pahlavi logograms
- Index (publishing)
- Terminology extraction

References [edit]

1. ^ R. Navigli, P. Velardi. From Glossaries to Ontologies: Extracting Semantic Structure from Textual Definitions, Ontology Learning and Population: Bridging the Gap between Text and Knowledge (P. Buitelaar and P. Cimiano, Eds.), Series information for Frontiers in Artificial Intelligence and Applications, IOS Press, 2008, pp. 71-87.
2. ^ R. Navigli. Using Cycles and Quasi-Cycles to Disambiguate Dictionary Glosses, Proc. of 12th Conference of the European Association for Computational Linguistics (EACL 2009), Athens, Greece, March 30-April 3rd, 2009, pp. 594-602.
3. ^ J. Klavans and S. Muresan. Evaluation of the Definder System for Fully Automatic Glossary Construction Archived 2019-12-22 at the Wayback Machine. In *Proc. of American Medical Informatics Association Symp.*, 2001, pp. 324–328.
4. ^ A. Fujii, T. Ishikawa. Utilizing the World Wide Web as an Encyclopedia: Extracting Term Descriptions from Semi-Structured Texts. In *Proc. 38th Ann. Meeting Assoc. for Computational Linguistics*, 2000, pp. 488–495.
5. ^ P. Velardi, R. Navigli, P. D'Amadio. Mining the Web to Create Specialised Glossaries, IEEE Intelligent Systems, 23(5), IEEE Press, 2008, pp. 18-25.

External links [edit]

- glossarist.com: The Glossarist - Large list of glossaries
- www.ontopia.net: The TAO of Topic Maps
- www.babel-linguistics.com: Babel Linguistics Glossaries Selected Multilingual Glossaries by Industry
- Hessels, John Henry (1911). "Gloss, Glossary". In Chisholm, Hugh (ed.). *Encyclopædia Britannica*. Vol. 12 (11th ed.). Cambridge University Press. pp. 124–128. This provides a detailed description of the development of glossaries in classical languages.

Look up ***glossary*** in Wiktionary, the free dictionary.

v · t · e	**Book design**	[show]
v · t · e	**Lexicography**	[show]
	Authority control databases	[show]

Categories: Glossaries | Book design | Lexicography

This page was last edited on 27 June 2025, at 02:59 (UTC).

Text is available under the Creative Commons Attribution-ShareAlike 4.0 License; additional terms may apply. By using this site, you agree to the Terms of Use and Privacy Policy. Wikipedia® is a registered trademark of the Wikimedia Foundation, Inc., a non-profit organization.

Privacy policy About Wikipedia Disclaimers Contact Wikipedia Code of Conduct Developers Statistics Cookie statement Mobile view

a WIKIMEDIA project
Powered by MediaWiki